

Litecoin's network is often used as a testing ground for Bitcoin software updates, given that Litecoin is nimbler than Bitcoin because it stores a fraction of the monetary value. It has also been used as the basis for other cryptoassets. At the start of 2017, litecoin was the fourth largest cryptoasset in terms of network value.<sup>20</sup>

## Ripple

Ripple is a cryptocurrency created in 2004 by Ryan Fugger, a web developer from Vancouver, British Columbia. Work on the project actually began before Satoshi and Bitcoin,<sup>21</sup> when Fugger was searching for a way to allow communities to create a system of money out of chains of trust. For example, if Alice trusts Bob, and Bob trusts Candace, and Candace trusts Dave, then Alice can send money to Dave (whom she doesn't know) by first transferring value to Bob, who transfers that same value to Candace, who takes that value and deposits it in Dave's account. Using this concept, payments can "ripple" through the network via these chains of trust. Fugger called this concept [RipplePay.com](http://RipplePay.com).

While Fugger's RipplePay did grow to 4,000 users,<sup>22</sup> it did not catch fire the way bitcoin did. In August 2012, Fugger was approached by the notable financial innovators Chris Larsen and Jed McCaleb. Larsen had founded E-Loan—one of the first companies to provide access to mortgage loans online—and Prosper, a leader in the peer-to-peer lending space.<sup>23</sup> McCaleb was the founder of Mt. Gox, the biggest bitcoin and cryptocurrency exchange in the world at that time.